ELASTIC{ON} NEW YORK · OCT 8 · POST-EVENT

How regulated security buys in the AI era, as the buyers told it

Their slides, redrawn in talk order. Every stage from first pain to what's next.

PROBLEM | WHAT AI CHANGED | CRITERIA | LANDSCAPE | WHY THEY BOUGHT | BUILD | NEXT

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CVP Security Engineering · New York Life

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01 PROBLEM · NEW YORK LIFE

Raising the bar: where we wanted to grow

"Took us two years to get there for reasons which you'll see shortly."

01

SIEM data management

Our legacy SIEM served us well as a structured database. But traditional SIEMs were not designed as fast analytics engines, and we wanted large-scale searches to be fast and routine.

02

Scaling with our data

With hundreds of log sources spanning network, endpoint, cloud, and application layers, our previous tooling served us well but was not keeping pace with the growth in our data.

03

Detection engineering

Years of custom detections captured real expertise. We wanted a platform that makes managing, tuning, and evolving them easier as threats change.

04

SOC workflow

SOAR and analyst workflows have evolved significantly over the past five years. Our previous tool served its era well, but it was not designed for the modern SOC.

> *"…we're spending fifty percent of the cost of the tool on retention, which is absurd."*
> Picheria, on the old tool

Source: Sal Picheria, New York Life, slide 3 (00:20) · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

Security data was scaling faster than manual operations

Cloud, applications, services, and AI increased both telemetry and investigative demand.

01 More services
Cloud, applications, and AI solutions expanded the monitoring footprint.

02 More signals
Each new service introduced more logs, alerts, and investigative context.

03 More analysis
Analysts had to connect identity, endpoint, cloud, network, and threat data.

04 More workload
The volume was growing faster than a team could reasonably staff.

05 Automation required
We needed to automate triage, investigations, hunting, and repetitive work.

Source: Jonathan Reitnauer, Vanguard, keynote slide (01:53) · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

AI raised the threat and rewired the tooling

THREATS

"Bad actors have access to frontier models. They have access to Chinese models."

Reitnauer: enterprises have to build AI responsibly, so attackers start ahead. "We cannot wait five years from now."

"The velocity of threat actors is definitely increasing."

Picheria: an optimized analyst experience is "really the only way to make this work."

TOOLING

The schema became an AI feature

ECS is "in the training set of essentially every frontier model," so nobody has to explain the data model to Claude.

Non-SOC teams build with agents

"We hand them the Elastic Agent Builder… 'I want this dashboard on this data.' Boom, boom, boom."

SOAR + AI

SOAR did "a pretty good job." Add AI: "a force multiplier." Autonomous triage is "critical."

Static rules are done

UI-based rule management and static versions "absolutely does not work anymore."

Sources: Reitnauer keynote · Picheria breakout · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

Data lake or SIEM? Breaking down what we found

After exhaustive research, we concluded that neither was a good fit for us on its own.

	DATA LAKES	SIEMS
DATA MODEL	No mature standard	Structured; maturity varies
ANALYTICS	Essentially limitless	Not designed for freeform analytics
RULES	—	Optimized for rules
EASE OF USE	High bar, usually SQL-style	—
RETENTION	Low-cost	Costly
DEPLOYMENT	Typically tied to one cloud & region	Typically tied to one cloud & region
PORTABILITY	—	Data hard to get out
PRICING	Unpredictable	Mostly ingest-based

Strength Mixed Trade-off

WHAT WE NEEDED

1. Robust, stable data model
2. Freeform analytics and rules, in balance
3. Low barrier for non-SOC security users
4. Raw and schematized data, side by side
5. Deploys where our data and compute live, across regions and clouds
6. Dial up performance when needed, balance cost

Source: Picheria, slide 4 (02:35). Buying both "was quickly axed by leadership for cost reasons." · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

04 VENDOR EVALUATION · BOTH BUYERS

What we needed, and what we get

NYL NEEDED		WHAT THEY GET
Robust, stable data model	› › ›	An open, mature common schema shared across all our data
Freeform analytics and rules, in balance	› › ›	Fast freeform search and detection rules on the same data, in one platform
Low barrier for non-SOC security users	› › ›	Intuitive search and dashboards any security team member can use
Raw and schematized data, side by side	› › ›	Normalized fields and the original raw event, stored together
Deploys where our data and compute live	› › ›	Runs in the clouds and regions where our data already lives, searchable as one
Dial up performance, balance cost	› › ›	Tiered storage: performance where it matters, low-cost retention everywhere else

VANGUARD · ITS FOUR CRITERIA

01 Reliability: no re-architecting "every six months"

02 Automation first

03 The AI direction

04 A partner to "help build it"

Sources: Picheria, slide 5 (09:30) · Reitnauer, keynote · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

05 WHY THEY BOUGHT · BOTH BUYERS

Why we chose Elastic

Enterprise scale without compromise	A distributed architecture built for our data's volume, velocity, and variety, with no artificial ingest limits.
Unified SIEM + security analytics	SIEM, threat hunting, and data lake in one platform, so analysts work in one place.
Open ecosystem	An open data model that fits our existing pipelines, bringing hundreds of sources onto one platform.
Enterprise security & compliance	The governance, access, and retention controls our risk and compliance teams require.
A true implementation partnership	Elastic experts alongside our team, from design through handover.

NYL · THE DECISION

After rigorous evaluation, Elastic was the clear answer: one platform for SIEM, data lake scale, open ecosystem flexibility, and enterprise governance.

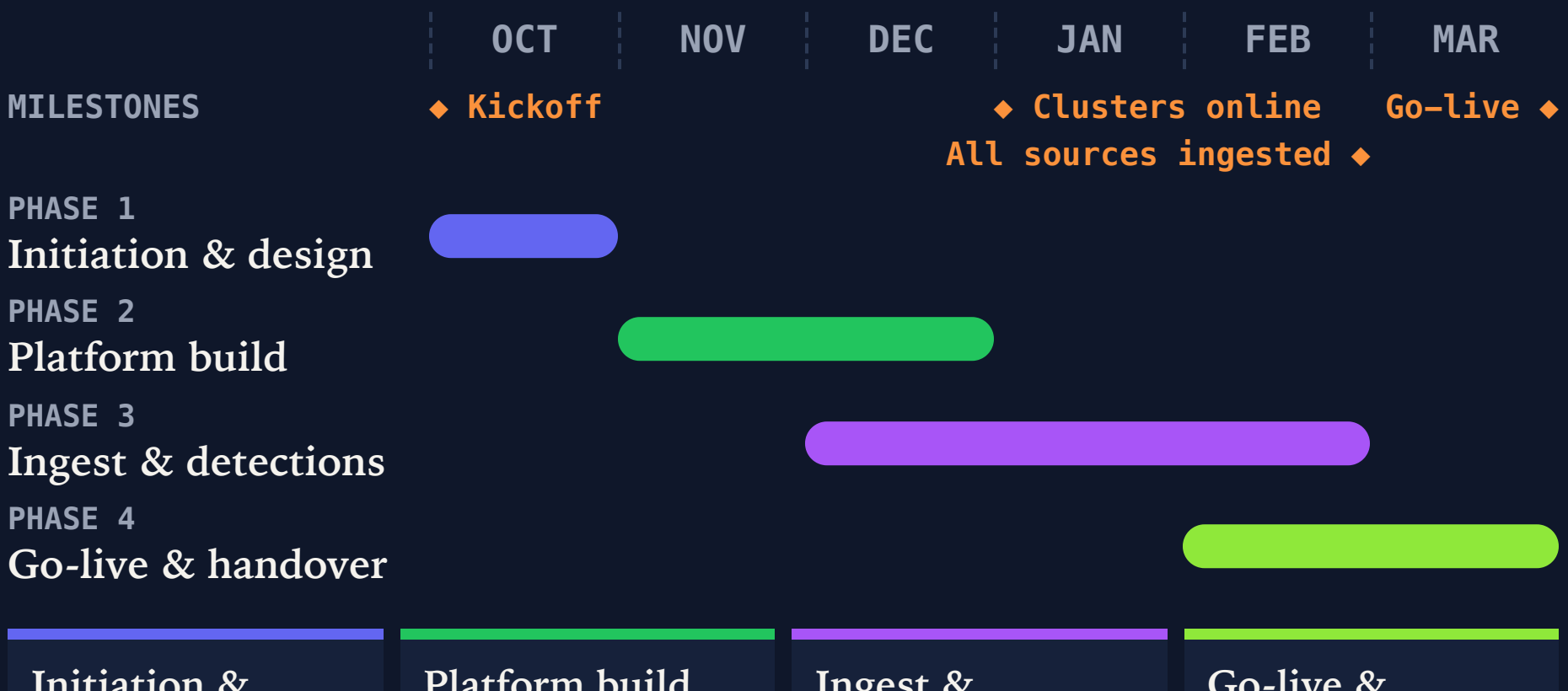
VANGUARD · BOUGHT THE ROADMAP

"Elastic was still very, very early in their AI direction when we went with them." A roadmap sneak peek, and "hard conversations and transparent road-map alignment."

Sources: Picheria, slide 9 (18:46) · Reitnauer, keynote + slide "The Foundation Is Already Delivering Value" · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

The implementation journey: 6 months

"Six months, started in October, we were done by March."



Initiation & design

Kickoff & planning · use cases & milestones · RBAC & ILM strategy · architecture designed

Platform build

Elastic Cloud clusters · non-prod & prod · SAML/SSO & RBAC · 3rd-party integrations

Ingest & detections

All log sources · custom + OOTB pipelines · rules migrated · dashboards · dual operations

Go-live & handover

Production go-live · QA/UAT · runbooks · SOC up and running · old SIEM decommissioned

> *"The strategic aspect of it, I think, was the hardest part."*
>
> Picheria. A long POC came first; two Elastic services people embedded; ~1 month of parallel run.

Source: Picheria, slide 8 (16:53) + talk · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

Elastic cyber data architecture: 3 clusters

SOURCES
tens of thousands of devices · 100s of log sources

LOG PIPELINE
enterprise pipeline in NYL's own AWS

no public-internet transfer charges

AWS PRIVATELINK

ELASTIC CLOUD · AWS

DATA LAKE
whole security org

SIEM
SOC detections

MONITORING
audit + query logs

CROSS-CLUSTER SEARCH

separate clusters = NYL's choice, not a requirement

SOAR-STYLE ORCHESTRATION ON TOP

Source: Sal Picheria, New York Life, Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08 (slide 6, 12:20, simplified; separate non-prod lane not shown)

A paved road into Elastic

How we onboarded 20 teams and 200 users in a year.

Request

1

Team opens a ticket

Code

2

We add the team to Terraform vars

Automate

3

Spaces, roles, RBAC & API keys deploy automatically

Access

4

Users request access; SSO groups map to roles

Land

5

Team signs in with SSO, straight into its own space

BUILT ON

Kibana Spaces

Native separation of each team's dashboards, rules, and content

Granular RBAC

Fine-grained, role-based access down to the data each team should see

Terraform

The glue: every role, space, mapping, and key managed as code

New teams onboarded in hours, not weeks, with no manual cluster changes

Source: Picheria, slide 7 (14:14). Spoken: "data lake as code," 10–15 minutes per team · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

The foundation is already delivering value

Elastic on AWS improved day-to-day operations and changed how the team approaches scale.

01 **Faster resolution**
Analysts resolve alerts in minutes instead of hours.

02 **Greater stability**
Better uptime, fewer monitoring errors, and fewer incomplete searches.

03 **Automation at scale**
As Elastic scales, automation scales alongside it.

04 **Culture shift**
Every new task starts with: "How do we automate that?"

05 **Partnership**
Hard conversations and transparent road-map alignment helped produce value.

> *"Every single alert has automation built into it. No alert doesn't."*
>
> Reitnauer. Handlers took a while to trust alerts that close themselves.

Source: Reitnauer, keynote slide (04:06). Vendor-event slide; no before/after figures given · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

The future SOC: AI executes, humans govern

Machine-speed investigation operates on trusted data, with people accountable for consequential decisions.

01 · TRUSTED

Trusted data foundation

Connect identity, endpoint, cloud, network, application, and threat intelligence context.

- Unified identity & endpoint logs
- Real-time cloud & network telemetry
- Integrated threat intelligence

02 · AI POWERED

AI-powered execution

Automate triage, correlation, investigation, timelines, and response recommendations.

- Machine-speed alert triage
- Automated cross-signal correlation
- Generated investigation timelines

03 · GOVERNANCE

Human accountability

Retain people for risk decisions, sensitive containment, business impact, governance, and AI oversight.

- Strategic risk assessment
- Sensitive action authorization
- Continuous model & policy oversight

THE DETECTION LIFECYCLE HE'S BUILDING

Threat intel in	Scored for our environment	Auto hunt	Detection drafted + back-tested	"I wanna hit the button"	Deployed: SIEM · EDR · IPS

> *"We don't wanna just hire analysts anymore."*
>
> Next hire: AI skills + developer skills + security background.
> NYL's next step: federated search over data still in other clouds.

Sources: Reitnauer, keynote slide (06:29) + talk · Picheria (12:20) · Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08

FOR SELLERS IN REGULATED SECURITY

The seller's cheat sheet

PROBLEM	Discover the old setup's economics, not a missing feature
AI SHIFT	Pitch pace against an AI-equipped attacker
CRITERIA	Sell predictability; multi-thread past the SOC
LANDSCAPE	Their category isn't yours. Forecast the survey years
WHY	Diagnose maturity buyer vs roadmap buyer
BUILD	Services and change management belong in the deal
NEXT	Your next champion is a builder, not an analyst

Derived from Picheria (New York Life) + Reitnauer (Vanguard), Elastic{ON} NYC 2026-10-08